CURTIN EXECUTIVE EDUCATION

Workbook

AI for professionals: building everyday capability

Use this workbook on your laptop (Word version) or on paper (PDF). Everything you write here is yours to keep: your prompt library, your redesigned workflow and your action plan. Copyable prompts, the scenario cards and the data file are on the course site: **michael-borck.github.io/ai-in-practice**.

SESSION	TIME	TOOL	EXERCISES
1 · Judge	9:00	Trust tool	1 Same prompt, two tools · 2 Place it
2 · Brief	11:00	RTCF	3 Brief it · 4 Upgrade and save
3 · Check	1:15	Check loop	5 RetailFlow · 6 Verification challenge
4 · Redesign	3:00	Opportunity Finder	7 Redesign one workflow · 8 Action plan

Exercise 1 · Same prompt, two tools

Paste this prompt, unedited, into two different AI tools (or two models in the same tool):

> I manage a team of 8 in a mid-sized company. One of my team, a strong performer for three years, has been late and missing deadlines for the past month. Others are starting to notice. Write me a plan to address this.

	TOOL 1: _____	TOOL 2: _____
What did it assume about you or the situation?		
What's missing?		
What would you not follow?		
Would you use it? (yes / partly / no)		

One piece of advice I would not follow, and why:

Exercise 2 · Place it

Card vote. Keep your cards face down until the count of three. Note any scenario where the room split.

Game. trusttool.borck.education · Domain: _____ · First-try score: ____ / 10

Three tasks from your own week.

TASK	EXACT OR AVERAGE?	SMALL OR LARGE STAKES?	CORNER (A - D)	THE CHECK IT NEEDS

Where I disagreed with my neighbour, and why:

Exercise 3 · Brief it

My task: _____ (or scenario card no. ___)

Round 1: the way I'd normally write it

Score (1 = unusable, 5 = ready to use): ____

Round 2: RTCF, in a fresh chat

PART	MY BRIEF
Role · who should it write as?	
Task · what exactly, how much?	
Context · audience, situation, constraints, stakes	
Format · length, structure, tone	

Score: ____ · The part that moved the score most: _____

Exercise 4 · Upgrade and save

UPGRADE I TRIED	LINE I ADDED	BETTER?
+ Example / + Done / + Questions / + Steps		

Pushback test. I pushed back without new evidence. It ☐ folded ☐ held. With the guardrail line it ☐ folded ☐ held.

> `Guardrail: Only change your assessment if I give you a new fact. Name the fact that changed it.`

My prompt library

Save three prompts you'll reuse this month. Put [blanks] where the details change, and attach the check each one needs.

	PROMPT 1	PROMPT 2	PROMPT 3
Name			
Use it when			
Role			
Task			
Context			
Format			
Upgrade			
Check (trust corner)			

Exercise 5 · RetailFlow: Karen needs answers by Monday

Karen manages customer service at RetailFlow. You have 260 tickets from July to December 2024 (`retailflow-customer-service-data.csv`, on the course site). Columns: ticket_id, date, day_of_week, month, category, channel, priority, agent, response_time_hours, resolution_time_hours, satisfaction_score, resolved.

01 Frame. Karen's questions: (1) What are the top three drivers of dissatisfaction? (2) When do response times blow out? (3) What should she do about it? Start a fresh chat.

02 Explore. First prompt: *"Describe this dataset: number of rows, columns, date range, and anything that looks incomplete."* Does it match what you were told? ☐ yes ☐ no

QUESTION	WHAT THE AI FOUND
Top drivers of dissatisfaction	
When response times blow out	
What Karen should do	

03 Verify two numbers yourself (spreadsheet filter, recount, or pivot table, not "are you sure?").

THE AI SAID	I CHECKED BY	RESULT
		☐ right ☐ close ☐ wrong
		☐ right ☐ close ☐ wrong

04 Shape. Your brief for Karen: under 300 words, ending with a line that starts *What I checked:*

Exercise 6 · Verification challenge

CLAIM	VERDICT	EVIDENCE FROM THE DATA
A "Email is roughly three times slower than Live Chat."	☐ Verified ☐ Overstated ☐ Refuted	
B "Account Issues has the lowest satisfaction of any category, which makes sense, because account problems are the most complex to resolve."	☐ Verified ☐ Overstated ☐ Refuted	
C "Sunday response times are more than double the overall average."	☐ Verified ☐ Overstated ☐ Refuted	

Which claim would have done the most damage if forwarded to Karen unchecked? Why?

Exercise 7 · Redesign one workflow

The task (weekly, 30 minutes or more): _____

Signals: Automate · Assist · Generate · Analyse. Who leads: AI leads · AI assists · You lead · Human only. Corners: A light review · B load-bearing bits · C before you ship · D human in the loop.

STEP	MINUTES NOW	SIGNAL	WHO LEADS	CORNER	MINUTES AFTER
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
Total					

The step I tested live, and what happened:

What I'd need to trust that step every week:

Exercise 8 · My action plan

One line each. Specific task, specific tool, specific day.

WHEN	MOVE	MY COMMITMENT
This week	Practise: one compare habit on a task that matters; use one saved prompt for real	
This month	Trade: run my redesigned workflow; hand over the steps AI has proven	
This quarter	Decide and revisit: name what must stay human in my role; check whether the line has moved	

Example: Thursday 9am: draft the steering committee update with my saved prompt, then compare it with my own.

☐ This week’s line is in my calendar.

What must human eyes still judge in my work?

What I’ll stop doing by hand, once it’s proven:

Field guide, prompt builder, data and slides: michael-borck.github.io/ai-in-practice · michael.borck@curtin.edu.au